

tive in terms of user interface and are gradually encouraging the developer world to build more and more apps for their platform. The ability to side-load Android apps is something that's also a little exciting for us geeks, but that's beyond the purview of this book. Watch the magazine and site for upcoming tutorials on this.

Why should you care?

It's obvious to the world that Apple's (iOS) and Google's (Android) offerings are the preferred OSes of choice today, and the fact that Android is open source and available from many more manufacturers also makes it a shoo-in to be at the top for a long time to come. So what's BlackBerry really fighting for? To give you a choice, for one, because what if you don't want to be limited to the top 2 OSes? Between BlackBerry and Windows, we now have a couple of more choices, for those who may not want to conform, or for those who prefer alternatives, and a different way of doing things. Thank <insert your choice of supreme being here> for options, or we'd all be listening to Justin Bieber all day if the music industry had their way! Monopolies also drive up prices and profits for the top companies, which means they can charge what they see fit. Android regulates itself by being open and multiple manufacturers compete with one another on the same platform, but iOS, for instance is solely Apple, and they can demand premium from those hooked on to their devices and services.

Plus, more players such as BlackBerry, Microsoft, and even the upcoming Firefox OS means more variety, and more companies pushing the envelope to innovate means better products are released for us to use. As we will detail through this book, there are some really interesting innovations being done by BlackBerry in terms of their OS and UI that we think others can learn from. It's not all good news of course, and there are some creases to be ironed out, but overall BlackBerry 10 is a bold step in a new direction for the company, and it's a good direction, as far as we're concerned. 